23 Isa · Isaiah

1 This is the vision concerning Judah and Jerusalem that Isaiah son of Amoz saw during the reigns of Uzziah, Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah, kings of Judah. [2] Listen, O heavens, and give ear, O earth, for the LORD has spoken: "I have raised children and brought them up, but they have rebelled against Me." [3] "The ox knows its owner, and the donkey its master's manger, but Israel does not know; My people do not understand." [4] Alas, O sinful nation, a people laden with iniquity, a brood of evildoers, children of depravity! They have forsaken the LORD; they have despised the Holy One of Israel and turned their backs on Him. [5] Why do you want more beatings? Why do you keep rebelling? Your head has a massive wound, and your whole heart is afflicted. [6] From the sole of your foot to the top of your head, there is no soundness— only wounds and welts and festering sores neither cleansed nor bandaged nor soothed with oil. [7] Your land is desolate; your cities are burned with fire. Foreigners devour your fields before you— a desolation demolished by strangers. [8] And the Daughter of Zion is abandoned like a shelter in a vineyard, like a shack in a cucumber field, like a city besieged. [9] Unless the LORD of Hosts had left us a few survivors, we would have become like Sodom, we would have resembled Gomorrah.

[10] Hear the word of the LORD, you rulers of Sodom; listen to the instruction of our God, you people of Gomorrah! [11] "What good to Me is your multitude of sacrifices?" says the LORD. "I am full from the burnt offerings of rams and the fat of well-fed cattle; I take no delight in the blood of bulls and lambs and goats." [12] When you come to appear before Me, who has required this of you— this trampling of My courts? [13] Bring your worthless offerings no more; your incense is detestable to Me— your New Moons, Sabbaths, and convocations. I cannot endure iniquity in a solemn assembly.

[14] I hate your New Moons and your appointed feasts. They have become a burden to Me; I am weary of bearing them. [15] When you spread out your hands in prayer, I will hide My eyes from you; even though you multiply your prayers, I will not listen. Your hands are covered with blood. [16] Wash and cleanse yourselves. Remove your evil deeds from My sight. Stop doing evil! [17] "Learn to do right; seek justice and correct the oppressor. Defend the fatherless and plead the case of the widow." [18] "Come now, let us reason together," says the LORD. "Though your sins are like scarlet, they will be as white as snow; though they are as red as crimson, they will become like wool." [19] If you are willing and obedient, you will eat the best of the land.

[20] "But if you resist and rebel, you will be devoured by the sword." For the mouth of the LORD has spoken. [21] See how the faithful city has become a harlot! She once was full of justice; righteousness resided within her, but now only murderers! [22] Your silver has become dross; your fine wine is diluted with water. [23] Your rulers are rebels, friends of thieves. They all love bribes and chasing after rewards. They do not defend the fatherless, and the plea of the widow never comes before them. [24] Therefore the Lord GOD of Hosts, the Mighty One of Israel, declares: "Ah, I will be relieved of My foes and avenge Myself on My enemies." [25] I will turn My hand against you; I will thoroughly purge your dross; I will remove all your impurities. [26] "I will restore your judges as at first, and your counselors as at the beginning. After that you will be called the City of Righteousness, the Faithful City." [27] Zion will be redeemed with justice, her repentant ones with righteousness. [28] But rebels and sinners will together be shattered, and those who forsake the LORD will perish. [29] Surely you will be ashamed of the sacred oaks in which you have delighted; you will be embarrassed by the gardens that you have chosen. [30] For you will become like an oak whose leaves are withered, like a garden without water. [31] The strong man will become tinder and his work will be a spark; both will burn together, with no one to quench the flames.

2 This is the message that was revealed to Isaiah son of Amoz concerning Judah and Jerusalem: [2] In the last days the mountain of the house of the LORD will be established as the chief of the mountains; it will be raised above the hills, and all nations will stream to it. [3] And many peoples will come and say: "Come, let us go up to the mountain of the LORD, to the house of the God of Jacob. He will teach us His ways so that we may walk in His paths." For the law will go forth from Zion, and the word of the LORD from Jerusalem. [4] Then He will judge between the nations and arbitrate for many peoples. They will beat their swords into plowshares and their spears into pruning hooks. Nation will no longer take up the sword against nation, nor train anymore for war. [5] Come, O house of Jacob, let us walk in the light of the LORD. [6] For You have abandoned Your people, the house of Jacob, because they are filled with influences from the east; they are soothsayers like the Philistines; they strike hands with the children of foreigners.

[7] Their land is full of silver and gold, with no limit to their treasures; their land is full of horses, with no limit to their chariots. [8] Their land is full of idols; they bow down to the work of their hands, to what their fingers have made. [9] So mankind is brought low, and man is humbled— do not forgive them!

[10] Go into the rocks and hide in the dust from the terror of the LORD and the splendor of His majesty. [11] The proud look of man will be humbled, and the loftiness of men brought low; the LORD alone will be exalted in that day. [12] For the Day of the LORD of Hosts will come against all the proud and lofty, against all that is exalted— it will be humbled— [13] against all the cedars of Lebanon, lofty and lifted up, against all the oaks of Bashan, [14] against all the tall mountains, against all the high hills, [15] against every high tower, against every fortified wall, [16] against every ship of Tarshish, and against every stately vessel. [17] So the pride of man will be brought low, and the loftiness of men will be humbled; the LORD alone will be exalted in that day, [18] and the idols will vanish completely. [19] Men will flee to caves in the rocks and holes in the ground, away from the terror of the LORD and from the splendor of His majesty, when He rises to shake the earth. [20] In that day men will cast away to the moles and bats their idols of silver and gold — the idols they made to worship. [21] They will flee to caverns in the rocks and crevices in the cliffs, away from the terror of the LORD and from the splendor of His majesty, when He rises to shake the earth. [22] Put no more trust in man, who has only the breath in his nostrils. Of what account is he?

3 For behold, the Lord GOD of Hosts is about to remove from Jerusalem and Judah both supply and support: the whole supply of food and water, [2] the mighty man and the warrior, the judge and the prophet, the soothsayer and the elder, [3] the commander of fifty and the dignitary, the counselor, the cunning magician, and the clever enchanter. [4] "I will make mere lads their leaders, and children will rule over them." [5] The people will oppress one another, man against man, neighbor against neighbor; the young will rise up against the old, and the base against the honorable. [6] A man will seize his brother within his father's house: "You have a cloak—you be our leader! Take charge of this heap of rubble." [7] On that day he will cry aloud: "I am not a healer. I have no food or clothing in my house. Do not make me leader of the people!"

[8] For Jerusalem has stumbled and Judah has fallen because they spoke and acted against the LORD, defying His glorious presence. [9] The expression on their faces testifies against them, and like Sodom they flaunt their sin; they do not conceal it. Woe to them, for they have brought disaster upon themselves. [10] Tell the righteous it will be well with them, for they will enjoy the fruit of their labor. [11] Woe to the wicked; disaster is upon them! For they will be repaid with what their hands have done.

[12] Youths oppress My people, and women rule over them. O My people, your guides mislead you; they turn you from your paths. [13] The LORD arises to contend; He stands to judge the people. [14] The LORD brings this charge against the elders and leaders of His people: "You have devoured the vineyard; the plunder of the poor is in your houses." [15] "Why do you crush My people and grind the faces of the poor?" declares the Lord GOD of Hosts. [16] The LORD also says: "Because the daughters of Zion are haughty— walking with heads held high and wanton eyes, prancing and skipping as they go, jingling the bracelets on their ankles—"

[17] "the Lord will bring sores on the heads of the daughters of Zion, and the LORD will make their foreheads bare." [18] In that day the Lord will take away their finery: their anklets and headbands and crescents; [19] their pendants, bracelets, and veils; [20] their headdresses, ankle chains, and sashes; their perfume bottles and charms; [21] their signet rings and nose rings; [22] their festive robes, capes, cloaks, and purses; [23] and their mirrors, linen garments, tiaras, and shawls. [24] Instead of fragrance there will be a stench; instead of a belt, a rope; instead of styled hair, baldness; instead of fine clothing, sackcloth; instead of beauty, shame. [25] Your men will fall by the sword, and your warriors in battle. [26] And the gates of Zion will lament and mourn; destitute, she will sit on the ground.

4 In that day seven women will take hold of one man and say, "We will eat our own bread and provide our own clothes. Just let us be called by your name. Take away our disgrace!" [2] On that day the Branch of the LORD will be beautiful and glorious, and the fruit of the land will be the pride and glory of Israel's survivors. [3] Whoever remains in Zion and whoever is left in Jerusalem will be called holy— all in Jerusalem who are recorded among the living— [4] when the Lord has washed away the filth of the daughters of Zion and cleansed the bloodstains from the heart of Jerusalem by a spirit of judgment and a spirit of fire. [5] Then the LORD will create over all of Mount Zion and over her assemblies a cloud of smoke by day and a glowing flame of fire by night. For over all the glory there will be a canopy, [6] a shelter to give shade from the heat by day, and a refuge and hiding place from the storm and the rain.

5 I will sing for my beloved a song of his vineyard: My beloved had a vineyard on a very fertile hill. [2] He dug it up and cleared the stones and planted the finest vines. He built a watchtower in the middle and dug out a winepress as well. He waited for the vineyard to yield good grapes, but the fruit it produced was sour! [3] "And now, O dwellers of Jerusalem and men of Judah, I exhort you to judge between Me and My vineyard." [4] What more could I have done for My vineyard than I already did for it? Why, when I expected sweet grapes, did it bring forth sour fruit? [5] Now I will tell you what I am about to do to My vineyard: I will take away its hedge, and it will be consumed; I will tear down its wall, and it will be trampled. [6] "I will make it a wasteland, neither pruned nor cultivated, and thorns and briers will grow up. I will command the clouds that rain shall not fall on it." [7] For the vineyard of the LORD of Hosts is the house of Israel, and the men of Judah are the plant of His delight. He looked for justice, but saw

bloodshed; for righteousness, but heard a cry of distress. [8] Woe to you who add house to house and join field to field until no place is left and you live alone in the land. [9] I heard the LORD of Hosts declare: "Surely many houses will become desolate, great mansions left unoccupied."

[10] "For ten acres of vineyard will yield but a bath of wine, and a homer of seed only an ephah of grain." [11] Woe to those who rise early in the morning in pursuit of strong drink, who linger into the evening, to be inflamed by wine. [12] At their feasts are the lyre and harp, tambourines and flutes and wine. They disregard the actions of the LORD and fail to see the work of His hands. [13] Therefore My people will go into exile for their lack of understanding; their dignitaries are starving and their masses are parched with thirst.

[14] Therefore Sheol enlarges its throat and opens wide its enormous jaws, and down go Zion's nobles and masses, her revelers and carousers! [15] So mankind will be brought low, and each man humbled; the arrogant will lower their eyes. [16] But the LORD of Hosts will be exalted by His justice, and the holy God will show Himself holy in righteousness. [17] Lambs will graze as in their own pastures, and strangers will feed in the ruins of the wealthy. [18] Woe to those who draw iniquity with cords of deceit and pull sin along with cart ropes, [19] to those who say, "Let Him hurry and hasten His work so that we may see it! Let the plan of the Holy One of Israel come so that we may know it!"

[20] Woe to those who call evil good and good evil, who turn darkness to light and light to darkness, who replace bitter with sweet and sweet with bitter. [21] Woe to those who are wise in their own eyes and clever in their own sight. [22] Woe to those who are heroes in drinking wine and champions in mixing strong drink, [23] who acquit the guilty for a bribe and deprive the innocent of justice. [24] Therefore, as a tongue of fire consumes the straw, and as dry grass shrivels in the flame, so their roots will decay and their blossoms will blow away like dust; for they have rejected the instruction of the LORD of Hosts and despised the word of the Holy One of Israel. [25] Therefore the anger of the LORD burns against His people; His hand is raised against them to strike them down. The mountains quake, and the corpses lay like refuse in the streets. Despite all this, His anger is not turned away; His hand is still upraised. [26] He lifts a banner for the distant nations and whistles for those at the ends of the earth. Behold—how speedily and swiftly they come! [27] None of them grows weary or stumbles; no one slumbers or sleeps. No belt is loose and no sandal strap is broken. [28] Their arrows are sharpened, and all their bows are strung. The hooves of their horses are like flint; their chariot wheels are like a whirlwind. [29] Their roaring is like that of a lion; they roar like young lions. They growl and seize their prey; they carry it away from deliverance. [30] In that day they will roar over it, like the roaring of the sea. If one looks over the land, he will see darkness and distress; even the light will be obscured by clouds.

6 In the year that King Uzziah died, I saw the Lord seated on a throne, high and exalted; and the train of His robe filled the temple. [2] Above Him stood seraphim, each having six wings: With two wings they covered their faces, with two they covered their feet, and with two they were flying. [3] And they were calling out to one another: "Holy, holy, holy is the LORD of Hosts; all the earth is full of His glory." [4] At the sound of their voices the doorposts and thresholds shook, and the temple was filled with smoke. [5] Then I said: "Woe is me, for I am ruined, because I am a man of unclean lips dwelling among a people of unclean lips; for my eyes have seen the King, the LORD of Hosts." [6] Then one of the seraphim flew to me, and in his hand was a glowing coal that he had taken with tongs from the altar. [7] And with it he touched my mouth and said: "Now that this has touched your lips, your iniquity is removed and your sin is atoned for." [8] Then I heard the voice of the Lord saying: "Whom shall I send? Who will go for Us?" And I said: "Here am I. Send me!" [9] And He replied: "Go and tell this people, 'Be ever hearing, but never understanding; be ever seeing, but never perceiving.'" [10] "Make the hearts of this people calloused; deafen their ears and close their eyes. Otherwise they might see with their eyes, hear with their ears, understand with their hearts, and turn and be healed." [11] Then I asked: "How long, O Lord?" And He replied: "Until the cities lie ruined and without inhabitant, until the houses are left unoccupied and the land is desolate and ravaged," [12] until the LORD has driven men far away and the land is utterly forsaken. [13] "And though a tenth remains in the land, it will be burned again. As the terebinth and oak leave stumps when felled, so the holy seed will be a stump in the land."

7 Now in the days that Ahaz son of Jotham, the son of Uzziah, was king of Judah, Rezin king of Aram marched up to wage war against Jerusalem. He was accompanied by Pekah son of Remaliah the king of Israel, but he could not overpower the city. [2] When it was reported to the house of David that Aram was in league with Ephraim, the hearts of Ahaz and his people trembled like trees in the forest shaken by the wind. [3] Then the LORD said to Isaiah, "Go out with your son Shear-jashub to meet Ahaz at the end of the aqueduct that feeds the upper pool, on the road to the Launderer's Field," [4] and say to him: Calm down and be quiet. Do not be afraid or disheartened over these two smoldering stubs of firewood—over the fierce anger of Rezin and Aram and of the son of Remaliah. [5] For Aram, along with Ephraim and the son of Remaliah, has plotted your ruin, saying: [6] 'Let us invade Judah, terrorize it, and divide it among ourselves. Then we can install the son of Tabeal over it as king.' [7] But this is what the Lord GOD says: 'It will not arise; it will not happen.'

[8] For the head of Aram is Damascus, and the head of Damascus is Rezin. Within sixty-five years Ephraim will be shattered as a people. [9] "The head of Ephraim is Samaria, and the head of Samaria is the son of Remaliah. If you do not stand firm in your faith, then you will not stand at all.'" [10] Again the LORD spoke to Ahaz, saying, [11] "Ask for a sign from the LORD your God, whether from the depths of Sheol or the heights of heaven."

[12] But Ahaz replied, "I will not ask; I will not test the LORD." [13] Then Isaiah said, "Hear now, O house of David! Is it not enough to try the patience of men? Will you try the patience of my God as well?" [14] Therefore the Lord Himself will give you a sign: Behold, the virgin will be with child and will give birth to a son, and will call Him Immanuel. [15] By the time He knows enough to reject evil and choose good, He will be eating curds and honey.

[16] For before the boy knows enough to reject evil and choose good, the land of the two kings you dread will be laid waste. [17] "The LORD will bring on you and on your people and on the house of your father a time unlike any since the day Ephraim separated from Judah—He will bring the king of Assyria." [18] On that day the LORD will whistle to the flies at the farthest streams of the Nile and to the bees in the land of Assyria. [19] And they will all come and settle in the steep ravines and clefts of the rocks, in all the thornbushes and watering holes. [20] On that day the Lord will use a razor hired from beyond the Euphrates—the king of Assyria—to shave your head and the hair of your legs, and to remove your beard as well. [21] On that day a man will raise a young cow and two sheep, [22] and from the abundance of milk they give, he will eat curds; for all who remain in the land will eat curds and honey. [23] And on that day, in every place that had a thousand vines worth a thousand shekels of silver, only briers and thorns will be found. [24] Men will go there with bow and arrow, for the land will be covered with briers and thorns. [25] For fear of the briers and thorns, you will no longer traverse the hills once tilled by the hoe; they will become places for oxen to graze and sheep to trample.

8 Then the LORD said to me, "Take a large scroll and write on it with an ordinary stylus: Maher-shalal-hash-baz." [2] "And I will appoint for Myself trustworthy witnesses—Uriah the priest and Zechariah son of Jeberekiah." [3] And I had relations with the prophetess, and she conceived and gave birth to a son. The LORD said to me, "Name him Maher-shalal-hash-baz." [4] "For before the boy knows how to cry 'Father' or 'Mother,' the wealth of Damascus and the plunder of Samaria will be carried off by the king of Assyria." [5] And the LORD spoke to me further: [6] "Because this people has rejected the gently flowing waters of Shiloah and rejoiced in Rezin and the son of Remaliah," [7] the Lord will surely bring against them the mighty floodwaters of the Euphrates— the king of Assyria and all his pomp. It will overflow its channels and overrun its banks. [8] It will pour into Judah, swirling and sweeping over it, reaching up to the neck; its spreading streams will cover your entire land, O Immanuel! [9] Huddle together, O peoples, and be shattered; pay attention, all you distant lands; prepare for battle, and be shattered; prepare for battle, and be shattered! [10] "Devise a plan, but it will be thwarted; state a proposal, but it will not happen. For God is with us." [11] For this is what the LORD has spoken to me with a strong hand, instructing me not to walk in the way of this people: [12] "Do not call conspiracy everything these people regard as conspiracy. Do not fear what they fear; do not live in dread." [13] The LORD of Hosts is the One you shall regard as holy. Only He should be feared; only He should be dreaded.

[14] And He will be a sanctuary— but to both houses of Israel a stone of stumbling and a rock of offense, to the dwellers of Jerusalem a trap and a snare. [15] "Many will stumble over these; they will fall and be broken; they will be ensnared and captured." [16] Bind up the testimony and seal the law among my disciples. [17] I will wait for the LORD, who is hiding His face from the house of Jacob. I will put my trust in Him. [18] Here am I, and the children the LORD has given me as signs and symbols in Israel from the LORD of Hosts, who dwells on Mount Zion. [19] When men tell you to consult the spirits of the dead and the spiritists who whisper and mutter, shouldn't a people consult their God instead? Why consult the dead on behalf of the living? [20] To the law and to the testimony! If they do not speak according to this word, they have no light of dawn. [21] They will roam the land, dejected and hungry. When they are famished, they will become enraged; and looking upward, they will curse their king and their God. [22] Then they will look to the earth and see only distress and darkness and the gloom of anguish. And they will be driven into utter darkness.

9 Nevertheless, there will be no more gloom for those in distress. In the past He humbled the land of Zebulun and the land of Naphtali, but in the future He will honor the Way of the Sea, beyond the Jordan, Galilee of the nations: [2] The people walking in darkness have seen a great light; on those living in the land of the shadow of death, a light has dawned. [3] You have enlarged the nation and increased its joy. The people rejoice before You as they rejoice at harvest time, as men rejoice in dividing the plunder. [4] For as in the day of Midian You have shattered the yoke of their burden, the bar across their shoulders, and the rod of their oppressor. [5] For every trampling boot of battle and every garment rolled in blood will be burned as fuel for the fire. [6] For unto us a child is born, unto us a son is given, and the government will be upon His shoulders. And He will be called Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace.

[7] Of the increase of His government and peace there will be no end. He will reign on the throne of David and over his kingdom, to establish and sustain it with justice and righteousness from that time and forevermore. The zeal of the LORD of Hosts will accomplish this. [8] The Lord has sent a message against

Jacob, and it has fallen upon Israel. [9] All the people will know it— Ephraim and the dwellers of Samaria. With pride and arrogance of heart they will say: [10] "The bricks have fallen, but we will rebuild with finished stone; the sycamores have been felled, but we will replace them with cedars."

[11] The LORD has raised up the foes of Rezin against him and joined his enemies together. [12] Aram from the east and Philistia from the west have devoured Israel with open mouths. Despite all this, His anger is not turned away; His hand is still upraised. [13] But the people did not return to Him who struck them; they did not seek the LORD of Hosts.

[14] So the LORD will cut off Israel's head and tail, both palm branch and reed in a single day. [15] The head is the elder and honorable man, and the tail is the prophet who teaches lies. [16] For those who guide this people mislead them, and those they mislead are swallowed up. [17] Therefore the Lord takes no pleasure in their young men; He has no compassion on their fatherless and widows. For every one of them is godless and wicked, and every mouth speaks folly. Despite all this, His anger is not turned away; His hand is still upraised. [18] For wickedness burns like a fire that consumes the thorns and briers and kindles the forest thickets which roll upward in billows of smoke. [19] By the wrath of the LORD of Hosts the land is scorched, and the people are fuel for the fire. No man even spares his brother. [20] They carve out what is on the right, but they are still hungry; they eat what is on the left, but they are still not satisfied. Each one devours the flesh of his own offspring. [21] Manasseh devours Ephraim, and Ephraim Manasseh; together they turn against Judah. Despite all this, His anger is not turned away; His hand is still upraised.

10 Woe to those who enact unjust statutes and issue oppressive decrees, [2] to deprive the poor of fair treatment and withhold justice from the oppressed of My people, to make widows their prey and orphans their plunder. [3] What will you do on the day of reckoning when devastation comes from afar? To whom will you flee for help? Where will you leave your wealth? [4] Nothing will remain but to crouch among the captives or fall among the slain. Despite all this, His anger is not turned away; His hand is still upraised. [5] Woe to Assyria, the rod of My anger; the staff in their hands is My wrath. [6] I will send him against a godless nation; I will dispatch him against a people destined for My rage, to take spoils and seize plunder, and to trample them down like clay in the streets. [7] But this is not his intention; this is not his plan. For it is in his heart to destroy and cut off many nations. [8] "Are not all my commanders kings?" he says. [9] "Is not Calno like Carchemish? Is not Hamath like Arpad? Is not Samaria like Damascus?" [10] As my hand seized the idolatrous kingdoms whose images surpassed those of Jerusalem and Samaria, [11] "and as I have done to Samaria and its idols, will I not also do to Jerusalem and her idols?" [12] So when the Lord has completed all His work against Mount Zion and Jerusalem, He will say, "I will punish the king of Assyria for the fruit of his arrogant heart and the proud look in his eyes." [13] For he says: 'By the strength of my hand I have done this, and by my wisdom, for I am clever. I have removed the boundaries of nations and plundered their treasures; like a mighty one I subdued their rulers.' [14] "My hand reached as into a nest to seize the wealth of the nations. Like one gathering abandoned eggs, I gathered all the earth. No wing fluttered, no beak opened or chirped.'"

[15] Does an axe raise itself above the one who swings it? Does a saw boast over him who saws with it? It would be like a rod waving the one who lifts it, or a staff lifting him who is not wood! [16] Therefore the Lord GOD of Hosts will send a wasting disease among Assyria's stout warriors, and under his pomp will be kindled a fire like a burning flame. [17] And the Light of Israel will become a fire, and its Holy One a flame. In a single day it will burn and devour Assyria's thorns and thistles. [18] The splendor of its forests and orchards, both soul and body, it will completely destroy, as a sickness consumes a man. [19] The remaining trees of its forests will be so few that a child could count them. [20] On that day the remnant of Israel and the survivors of the house of Jacob will no longer depend on him who struck them, but they will truly rely on the LORD, the Holy One of Israel. [21] A remnant will return—a remnant of Jacob— to the Mighty God.

[22] Though your people, O Israel, be like the sand of the sea, only a remnant will return. Destruction has been decreed, overflowing with righteousness. [23] For the Lord GOD of Hosts will carry out the destruction decreed upon the whole land. [24] Therefore this is what the Lord GOD of Hosts says: "O My people who dwell in Zion, do not fear Assyria, who strikes you with a rod and lifts his staff against you as the Egyptians did." [25] "For in just a little while My fury against you will subside, and My anger will turn to their destruction." [26] And the LORD of Hosts will brandish a whip against them, as when He struck Midian at the rock of Oreb. He will raise His staff over the sea, as He did in Egypt. [27] On that day the burden will be lifted from your shoulders, and the yoke from your neck. The yoke will be broken because your neck will be too large. [28] Assyria has entered Aiath and passed through Migron, storing their supplies at Michmash. [29] They have crossed at the ford: "We will spend the night at Geba." Ramah trembles; Gibeah of Saul flees. [30] Cry aloud, O Daughter of Gallim! Listen, O Laishah! O wretched Anathoth! [31] Madmenah flees; the people of Gebim take refuge. [32] Yet today they will halt at Nob, shaking a fist at the mount of Daughter Zion, at the hill of Jerusalem. [33] Behold, the Lord GOD of Hosts will lop off the branches with terrifying power. The tall trees will be cut down, the lofty ones will be felled. [34] He will clear the forest thickets with an axe, and Lebanon will fall before the Mighty One.

11 Then a shoot will spring up from the stump of Jesse, and a Branch from his roots will bear fruit. [2] The Spirit of the LORD will rest on Him— the Spirit of wisdom and understanding, the Spirit of counsel and strength, the Spirit of knowledge and fear of the LORD. [3] And He will delight in the fear of the LORD. He will not judge by what His eyes see, and He will not decide by what His ears hear, [4] but with righteousness He will judge the poor, and with equity He will decide for the lowly of the earth. He will strike the earth with the rod of His mouth and slay the wicked with the breath of His lips. [5] Righteousness will be the belt around His hips, and faithfulness the sash around His waist. [6] The wolf will live with the lamb, and the leopard will lie down with the goat; the calf and young lion and fatling will be together, and a little child will lead them. [7] The cow will graze with the bear, their young will lie down together, and the lion will eat straw like the ox.

[8] The infant will play by the cobra's den, and the toddler will reach into the viper's nest. [9] They will neither harm nor destroy on all My holy mountain, for the earth will be full of the knowledge of the LORD as the sea is full of water. [10] On that day the Root of Jesse will stand as a banner for the peoples. The nations will seek Him, and His place of rest will be glorious. [11] On that day the Lord will extend His hand a second time to recover the remnant of His people from Assyria, from Egypt, from Pathros, from Cush, from Elam, from Shinar, from Hamath, and from the islands of the sea. [12] He will raise a banner for the nations and gather the exiles of Israel; He will collect the scattered of Judah from the four corners of the earth. [13] Then the jealousy of Ephraim will depart, and the adversaries of Judah will be cut off. Ephraim will no longer envy Judah, nor will Judah harass Ephraim. [14] They will swoop down on the slopes of the Philistines to the west; together they will plunder the sons of the east. They will lay their hands on Edom and Moab, and the Ammonites will be subject to them. [15] The LORD will devote to destruction the gulf of the Sea of Egypt; with a scorching wind He will sweep His hand over the Euphrates. He will split it into seven streams for men to cross with dry sandals. [16] There will be a highway for the remnant of His people who remain from Assyria, as there was for Israel when they came up from the land of Egypt.

12 In that day you will say: "O LORD, I will praise You. Although You were angry with me, Your anger has turned away, and You have comforted me." [2] "Surely God is my salvation; I will trust and not be afraid. For the LORD GOD is my strength and my song, and He also has become my salvation." [3] With joy you will draw water from the springs of salvation, [4] and on that day you will say: "Give praise to the LORD; proclaim His name! Make His works known among the peoples; declare that His name is exalted." [5] Sing to the LORD, for He has done glorious things. Let this be known in all the earth. [6] "Cry out and sing, O citizen of Zion, for great among you is the Holy One of Israel."

13 This is the burden against Babylon that Isaiah son of Amoz received: [2] Raise a banner on a barren hilltop; call aloud to them. Wave your hand, that they may enter the gates of the nobles. [3] I have commanded My sanctified ones; I have even summoned My warriors to execute My wrath and exult in My triumph. [4] Listen, a tumult on the mountains, like that of a great multitude! Listen, an uproar among the kingdoms, like nations gathered together! The LORD of Hosts is mobilizing an army for war. [5] They are coming from faraway lands, from the ends of the heavens— the LORD and the weapons of His wrath— to destroy the whole country. [6] Wail, for the Day of the LORD is near; it will come as destruction from the Almighty.

[7] Therefore all hands will fall limp, and every man's heart will melt. [8] Terror, pain, and anguish will seize them; they will writhe like a woman in labor. They will look at one another, their faces flushed with fear.

[9] Behold, the Day of the LORD is coming— cruel, with fury and burning anger— to make the earth a desolation and to destroy the sinners within it. [10] For the stars of heaven and their constellations will not give their light. The rising sun will be darkened, and the moon will not give its light. [11] I will punish the world for its evil and the wicked for their iniquity. I will end the haughtiness of the arrogant and lay low the pride of the ruthless. [12] I will make man scarcer than pure gold, and mankind rarer than the gold of Ophir. [13] Therefore I will make the heavens tremble, and the earth will be shaken from its place at the wrath of the LORD of Hosts on the day of His burning anger.

[14] Like a hunted gazelle, like a sheep without a shepherd, each will return to his own people, each will flee to his native land. [15] Whoever is caught will be stabbed, and whoever is captured will die by the sword. [16] Their infants will be dashed to pieces before their eyes, their houses will be looted, and their wives will be ravished. [17] Behold, I will stir up against them the Medes, who have no regard for silver and no desire for gold. [18] Their bows will dash young men to pieces; they will have no mercy on the fruit of the womb; they will not look with pity on the children. [19] And Babylon, the jewel of the kingdoms, the glory of the pride of the Chaldeans, will be overthrown by God like Sodom and Gomorrah. [20] She will never be inhabited or settled from generation to generation; no nomad will pitch his tent there, no shepherd will rest his flock there. [21] But desert creatures will lie down there, and howling creatures will fill her houses. Ostriches will dwell there, and wild goats will leap about. [22] Hyenas will howl in her fortresses and jackals in her luxurious palaces. Babylon's time is at hand, and her days will not be prolonged.

14 For the LORD will have compassion on Jacob; once again He will choose Israel and settle them in their own land. The foreigner will join them and unite with the house of Jacob. [2] The nations will escort Israel and bring it to its homeland. Then the house of Israel will possess the nations as menservants and maidservants in the LORD's land. They will make captives of their captors and rule over their oppressors. [3] On the day that the LORD gives you rest from your pain and torment, and from the hard labor into which you were forced, [4] you will sing this song of contempt against the king of Babylon: How the oppressor has ceased, and how his fury has ended! [5] The LORD has broken the staff of the wicked, the scepter of the rulers. [6] It struck the peoples in anger with unceasing blows; it subdued the nations in rage with relentless persecution. [7] All the earth is at peace and at rest; they break out in song. [8] Even the cypresses and cedars of Lebanon exult over you: "Since you have been laid low, no woodcutter comes against us." [9] Sheol beneath is eager to meet you upon your arrival. It stirs the spirits of the dead to greet you— all the rulers of the earth. It makes all the kings of the nations rise from their thrones.

[10] They will all respond to you, saying, "You too have become weak, as we are; you have become like us!" [11] Your pomp has been brought down to Sheol, along with the music of your harps. Maggots are your bed and worms your blanket. [12] How you have fallen from heaven, O day star, son of the dawn! You have been cut down to the ground, O destroyer of nations. [13] You said in your heart: "I will ascend to the heavens; I will raise my throne above the stars of God. I will sit on the mount of assembly, in the far reaches of the north." [14] "I will ascend above the tops of the clouds; I will make myself like the Most High."

[15] But you will be brought down to Sheol, to the lowest depths of the Pit. [16] Those who see you will stare; they will ponder your fate: "Is this the man who shook the earth and made the kingdoms tremble," [17] "who turned the world into a desert and destroyed its cities, who refused to let the captives return to their homes?" [18] All the kings of the nations lie in state, each in his own tomb. [19] But you are cast out of your grave like a rejected branch, covered by those slain with the sword, and dumped into a rocky pit like a carcass trampled underfoot. [20] You will not join them in burial, since you have destroyed your land and slaughtered your own people. The offspring of the wicked will never again be mentioned.

[21] Prepare a place to slaughter his sons for the iniquities of their forefathers. They will never rise up to possess a land or cover the earth with their cities. [22] "I will rise up against them," declares the LORD of Hosts. "I will cut off from Babylon her name and her remnant, her offspring and her posterity," declares the LORD. [23] "I will make her a place for owls and for swamplands; I will sweep her away with the broom of destruction," declares the LORD of Hosts. [24] The LORD of Hosts has sworn: "Surely, as I have planned, so will it be; as I have purposed, so will it stand." [25] "I will break Assyria in My land; I will trample him on My mountain. His yoke will be taken off My people, and his burden removed from their shoulders." [26] This is the plan devised for the whole earth, and this is the hand stretched out over all the nations. [27] The LORD of Hosts has purposed, and who can thwart Him? His hand is outstretched, so who can turn it back? [28] In the year that King Ahaz died, this burden was received: [29] Do not rejoice, all you Philistines, that the rod that struck you is broken. For a viper will spring from the root of the snake, and a flying serpent from its egg. [30] Then the firstborn of the poor will find pasture, and the needy will lie down in safety, but I will kill your root by famine, and your remnant will be slain. [31] Wail, O gate! Cry out, O city! Melt away, all you Philistines! For a cloud of smoke comes from the north, and there are no stragglers in its ranks. [32] What answer will be given to the envoys of that nation? "The LORD has founded Zion, where His afflicted people will find refuge."

15 This is the burden against Moab: Ar in Moab is ruined, destroyed in a night! Kir in Moab is devastated, destroyed in a night! [2] Dibon goes up to its temple to weep at its high places. Moab wails over Nebo, as well as over Medeba. Every head is shaved, every beard is cut off. [3] In its streets they wear sackcloth; on the rooftops and in the public squares they all wail, falling down weeping. [4] Heshbon and Elealeh cry out; their voices are heard as far as Jahaz. Therefore the soldiers of Moab cry out; their souls tremble within. [5] My heart cries out over Moab; her fugitives flee as far as Zoar, as far as Eglath-shelishiyah. With weeping they ascend the slope of Luhith; they lament their destruction on the road to Horonaim. [6] The waters of Nimrim are dried up, and the grass is withered; the vegetation is gone, and the greenery is no more. [7] So they carry their wealth and belongings over the Brook of the Willows. [8] For their outcry echoes to the border of Moab. Their wailing reaches Eglaim; it is heard in Beer-elim. [9] The waters of Dimon are full of blood, but I will bring more upon Dimon— a lion upon the fugitives of Moab and upon the remnant of the land.

16 Send the tribute lambs to the ruler of the land, from Sela in the desert to the mount of Daughter Zion. [2] Like fluttering birds pushed out of the nest, so are the daughters of Moab at the fords of the Arnon: [3] "Give us counsel; render a decision. Shelter us at noonday with shade as dark as night. Hide the refugees; do not betray the one who flees." [4] "Let my fugitives stay with you; be a refuge for Moab from the destroyer." When the oppressor has gone, destruction has ceased, and the oppressors have vanished from the land, [5] in loving devotion a throne will be established in the tent of David. A judge seeking justice and hastening righteousness will sit on it in faithfulness. [6] We have heard of Moab's pomposity, his exceeding pride and conceit, his overflowing arrogance. But his boasting is empty. [7] Therefore let Moab wail; let them wail together for Moab. Moan for the raisin cakes of Kir-hareseth, you who are utterly stricken. [8] For the fields of Heshbon have withered, along with the grapevines of Sibmah. The rulers of the nations have trampled its choicest vines, which had reached as far as Jazer and spread toward the desert. Their shoots had spread out and passed over the sea. [9] So I weep with Jazer for the vines of Sibmah; I drench Heshbon and Elealeh with my tears. Triumphant shouts have fallen silent over your summer fruit and your harvest. [10] Joy and gladness are removed from the orchard; no one sings or shouts in the vineyards. No one tramples the grapes in the winepresses; I have put an end to the cheering. [11] Therefore my heart laments for Moab like a harp, my inmost being for Kir-heres. [12] When Moab appears on the high place, when he wearies himself and enters his sanctuary to pray, it will do him no good. [13] This is the message that the LORD spoke earlier concerning Moab. [14] And now the LORD says, "In three years, as a hired worker counts the years, Moab's splendor will become an object of contempt, with all her many people. And those who are left will be few and feeble."

17 This is the burden against Damascus: "Behold, Damascus is no longer a city; it has become a heap of ruins." [2] The cities of Aroer are forsaken; they will be left to the flocks, which will lie down with no one to fear. [3] "The fortress will disappear from Ephraim, and the sovereignty from Damascus. The remnant of Aram will be like the splendor of the Israelites," declares the LORD of Hosts. [4] "In that day the splendor of Jacob will fade, and the fat of his body will waste away," [5] as the reaper gathers the standing grain and harvests the ears with his arm, as one gleans heads of grain in the Valley of Rephaim. [6] "Yet gleanings will remain, like an olive tree that has been beaten— two or three berries atop the tree, four or five on its fruitful branches," declares the LORD, the God of Israel. [7] In that day men will look to their Maker and turn their eyes to the Holy One of Israel. [8] They will not look to the altars they have fashioned with their hands or to the Asherahs and incense altars they have made with their fingers. [9] In that day their strong cities will be like forsaken thickets and summits, abandoned to the Israelites and to utter desolation. [10] For you have forgotten the God of your salvation and failed to remember the Rock of your refuge. Therefore, though you cultivate delightful plots and set out cuttings from exotic vines— [11] though on the day you plant you make them grow, and on that morning you help your seed sprout— yet the harvest will vanish on the day of disease and incurable pain. [12] Alas, the tumult of many peoples; they rage like the roaring seas and clamoring nations; they rumble like the crashing of mighty waters. [13] The nations rage like the rush of many waters. He rebukes them, and they flee far away, driven before the wind like chaff on the hills, like tumbleweeds before a gale. [14] In the evening, there is sudden terror! Before morning, they are no more! This is the portion of those who loot us and the lot of those who plunder us.

18 Woe to the land of whirring wings, along the rivers of Cush, [2] which sends couriers by sea, in papyrus vessels on the waters. Go, swift messengers, to a people tall and smooth-skinned, to a people widely feared, to a powerful nation of strange speech, whose land is divided by rivers. [3] All you people of the world and dwellers of the earth, when a banner is raised on the mountains, you will see it; when a ram's horn sounds, you will hear it. [4] For this is what the LORD has told me: "I will quietly look on from My dwelling place, like shimmering heat in the sunshine, like a cloud of dew in the heat of harvest." [5] For before the harvest, when the blossom is gone and the flower becomes a ripening grape, He will cut off the shoots with a pruning knife and remove and discard the branches. [6] They will all be left to the mountain birds of prey, and to the beasts of the land. The birds will feed on them in summer, and all the wild animals in winter. [7] At that time gifts will be brought to the LORD of Hosts— from a people tall and smooth-skinned, from a people widely feared, from a powerful nation of strange speech, whose land is divided by rivers— to Mount Zion, the place of the Name of the LORD of Hosts.

19 This is the burden against Egypt: Behold, the LORD rides on a swift cloud; He is coming to Egypt. The idols of Egypt will tremble before Him, and the hearts of the Egyptians will melt within them. [2] "So I will incite Egyptian against Egyptian; brother will fight against brother, neighbor against neighbor, city against city, and kingdom against kingdom." [3] Then the spirit of the Egyptians will be emptied out from among them, and I will frustrate their plans, so that they will resort to idols and spirits of the dead, to mediums and spiritists. [4] "I will deliver the Egyptians into the hands of harsh masters, and a fierce king will rule over them," declares the Lord GOD of Hosts. [5] The waters of the Nile will dry up, and the riverbed will be parched and empty. [6] The canals will stink; the streams of Egypt will trickle and dry up; the reeds and rushes will wither. [7] The bulrushes by the Nile, by the mouth of the river, and all the fields sown along the Nile, will wither, blow away, and be no more.

[8] Then the fishermen will mourn, all who cast a hook into the Nile will lament, and those who spread nets on the waters will pine away. [9] The workers in flax will be dismayed, and the weavers of fine linen will turn pale. [10] The workers in cloth will be dejected, and all the hired workers will be sick at heart. [11] The princes of Zoan are mere fools; Pharaoh's wise counselors give senseless advice. How can you say to Pharaoh, "I am one of the wise, a son of eastern kings"?

[12] Where are your wise men now? Let them tell you and reveal what the LORD of Hosts has planned against Egypt. [13] The princes of Zoan have become fools;

the princes of Memphis are deceived. The cornerstones of her tribes have led Egypt astray. [14] The LORD has poured into her a spirit of confusion. Egypt has been led astray in all she does, as a drunkard staggers through his own vomit. [15] There is nothing Egypt can do— head or tail, palm or reed.

[16] In that day the Egyptians will be like women. They will tremble with fear beneath the uplifted hand of the LORD of Hosts, when He brandishes it against them. [17] The land of Judah will bring terror to Egypt; whenever Judah is mentioned, Egypt will tremble over what the LORD of Hosts has planned against it. [18] In that day five cities in the land of Egypt will speak the language of Canaan and swear allegiance to the LORD of Hosts. One of them will be called the City of the Sun. [19] In that day there will be an altar to the LORD in the center of the land of Egypt, and a pillar to the LORD near her border. [20] It will be a sign and a witness to the LORD of Hosts in the land of Egypt. When they cry out to the LORD because of their oppressors, He will send them a savior and defender to rescue them. [21] The LORD will make Himself known to Egypt, and on that day Egypt will acknowledge the LORD. They will worship with sacrifices and offerings; they will make vows to the LORD and fulfill them. [22] And the LORD will strike Egypt with a plague; He will strike them but heal them. They will turn to the LORD, and He will hear their prayers and heal them. [23] In that day there will be a highway from Egypt to Assyria. The Assyrians will go to Egypt, and the Egyptians to Assyria. The Egyptians and Assyrians will worship together. [24] In that day Israel will join a three-party alliance with Egypt and Assyria—a blessing upon the earth. [25] The LORD of Hosts will bless them, saying, "Blessed be Egypt My people, Assyria My handiwork, and Israel My inheritance."

20 Before the year that the chief commander, sent by Sargon king of Assyria, came to Ashdod and attacked and captured it, [2] the LORD had already spoken through Isaiah son of Amoz, saying, "Go, remove the sackcloth from your waist and the sandals from your feet." And Isaiah did so, walking around naked and barefoot. [3] Then the LORD said, "Just as My servant Isaiah has gone naked and barefoot for three years as a sign and omen against Egypt and Cush," [4] so the king of Assyria will lead away the captives of Egypt and the exiles of Cush, young and old alike, naked and barefoot, with bared buttocks—to Egypt's shame. [5] Those who made Cush their hope and Egypt their boast will be dismayed and ashamed. [6] "And on that day the dwellers of this coastland will say, 'See what has happened to our source of hope, those to whom we fled for help and deliverance from the king of Assyria! How then can we escape?'"

21 This is the burden against the Desert by the Sea: Like whirlwinds sweeping through the Negev, an invader comes from the desert, from a land of terror. [2] A dire vision is declared to me: "The traitor still betrays, and the destroyer still destroys. Go up, O Elam! Lay siege, O Media! I will put an end to all her groaning." [3] Therefore my body is filled with anguish. Pain grips me, like the pains of a woman in labor. I am bewildered to hear, I am dismayed to see. [4] My heart falters; fear makes me tremble. The twilight of my desire has turned to horror. [5] They prepare a table, they lay out a carpet, they eat, they drink! Rise up, O princes, oil the shields! [6] For this is what the Lord says to me: "Go, post a lookout and have him report what he sees." [7] "When he sees chariots with teams of horsemen, riders on donkeys, riders on camels, he must be alert, fully alert."

[8] Then the lookout shouted: "Day after day, my lord, I stand on the watchtower; night after night I stay at my post." [9] "Look, here come the riders, horsemen in pairs." And one answered, saying: "Fallen, fallen is Babylon! All the images of her gods lie shattered on the ground!" [10] O my people, crushed on the threshing floor, I tell you what I have heard from the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel. [11] This is the burden against Dumah: One calls to me from Seir, "Watchman, what is left of the night? Watchman, what is left of the night?" [12] The watchman replies, "Morning has come, but also the night. If you would inquire, then inquire. Come back yet again." [13] This is the burden against Arabia: In the thickets of Arabia you must lodge, O caravans of Dedanites. [14] Bring water for the thirsty, O dwellers of Tema; meet the refugees with food. [15] For they flee from the sword— the sword that is drawn— from the bow that is bent, and from the stress of battle. [16] For this is what the Lord says to me: "Within one year, as a hired worker would count it, all the glory of Kedar will be gone." [17] "The remaining archers, the warriors of Kedar, will be few." For the LORD, the God of Israel, has spoken.

22 This is the burden against the Valley of Vision: What ails you now, that you have all gone up to the rooftops, [2] O city of commotion, O town of revelry? Your slain did not die by the sword, nor were they killed in battle. [3] All your rulers have fled together, captured without a bow. All your fugitives were captured together, having fled to a distant place. [4] Therefore I said, "Turn away from me, let me weep bitterly! Do not try to console me over the destruction of the daughter of my people." [5] For the Lord GOD of Hosts has set a day of tumult and trampling and confusion in the Valley of Vision— of breaking down the walls and crying to the mountains. [6] Elam takes up a quiver, with chariots and horsemen, and Kir uncovers the shield. [7] Your choicest valleys are full of chariots, and horsemen are posted at the gates.

[8] He has uncovered the defenses of Judah. On that day you looked to the weapons in the House of the Forest. [9] You saw that there were many breaches in the walls of the City of David. You collected water from the lower pool. [10] You counted the houses of Jerusalem and tore them down to strengthen the wall. [11] You built a reservoir between the walls for the waters of the ancient pool, but you did not look to the One who made it, or consider Him who planned it long ago. [12] On that day the Lord GOD of Hosts called for weeping and wailing, for shaven heads and the wearing of sackcloth. [13] But look, there is joy and gladness, butchering of cattle and slaughtering of sheep, eating of meat and drinking of wine: "Let us eat and drink, for tomorrow we die!" [14] The LORD of Hosts has revealed in my hearing: "Until your dying day, this sin of yours will never be atoned for," says the Lord GOD of Hosts. [15] This is what the Lord GOD of Hosts says: "Go, say to Shebna, the steward in charge of the palace:" [16] What are you doing here, and who authorized you to carve out a tomb for yourself here —to chisel your tomb in the height and cut your resting place in the rock?

[17] Look, O mighty man! The LORD is about to shake you violently. He will take hold of you, [18] roll you into a ball, and sling you into a wide land. There you will die, and there your glorious chariots will remain—a disgrace to the house of your master. [19] I will remove you from office, and you will be ousted from your position. [20] On that day I will summon My servant, Eliakim son of Hilkiah. [21] I will clothe him with your robe and tie your sash around him. I will put your authority in his hand, and he will be a father to the dwellers of Jerusalem and to the house of Judah. [22] I will place on his shoulder the key to the house of David. What he opens no one can shut, and what he shuts no one can open. [23] I will drive him like a peg into a firm place, and he will be a throne of glory for the house of his father. [24] So they will hang on him all the glory of his father's house: the descendants and the offshoots—all the lesser vessels, from bowls to every kind of jar. [25] "In that day, declares the LORD of Hosts, the peg driven into a firm place will give way; it will be sheared off and fall, and the load upon it will be cut down." Indeed, the LORD has spoken.

23 This is the burden against Tyre: Wail, O ships of Tarshish, for Tyre is laid waste, without house or harbor. Word has reached them from the land of Cyprus. [2] Be silent, O dwellers of the coastland, you merchants of Sidon, whose traders have crossed the sea. [3] On the great waters came the grain of Shihor; the harvest of the Nile was the revenue of Tyre; she was the merchant of the nations. [4] Be ashamed, O Sidon, the stronghold of the sea, for the sea has spoken: "I have not been in labor or given birth. I have not raised young men or brought up young women." [5] When the report reaches Egypt, they will writhe in agony over the news of Tyre. [6] Cross over to Tarshish; wail, O inhabitants of the coastland! [7] Is this your jubilant city, whose origin is from antiquity, whose feet have taken her to settle far away?